

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the International Arbitration Paralegal role at Ryder Reid Legal Limited because my year at BCLP's international arbitration team gave me direct, practical experience of the work this role involves, and I want to build on that in a firm where arbitration is a core specialism rather than one strand among many.

At BCLP I supported a complex investment arbitration from early procedural stages through to memorial preparation. I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, amended sections of the Claimant's memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and maintained structured electronic case files across the matter. Shortly before a significant deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team. I coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions across the team and helped ensure on-time submission. A partner and associate told me my performance at that point was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a working understanding of how a large arbitration is managed day to day, including the document control, deadline tracking and close coordination with counsel that the role here will require.

My LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary has developed the analytical side of that practical foundation. I have studied international arbitration procedure, evidence and jurisdictional issues at a level that means I can engage with legal research tasks in this area with some depth, not just carry them out mechanically. I also attended London International Disputes Week at Three Crowns and a King's College London seminar on abuse of process in international arbitration, which reflects a genuine interest in the field that goes beyond my formal study and work.

Outside arbitration, my current role as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice involves managing a caseload independently: taking detailed client statements, researching complex legal points, drafting correspondence and meeting submission deadlines. That has kept my case management and client communication skills sharp in a way that directly translates to supporting fee earners and clients in a busy disputes practice.

Ryder Reid's focus on high-value and complex disputes is what draws me to this role specifically. I want to work in an environment where arbitration is taken seriously as a discipline, and where the paralegal role involves real engagement with the substance of the work rather than purely administrative support. This role is the right next step for that.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva